

1.c) Phenomenology in Anthropological research

Phenomenology approach refers to the research method, which is lived experience of the research. It is developed in the era of Post-modernism, wherein, subjectivity is given more focus.

Features / Merits of phenomenology

- ① It gives too much liberty and agency to individual.
- ② tried to represent the element of subjectivity → every knowledge is true (~~reduce~~ Brings Eclecticism)
- ③ Reduces the Hermeneutic tendency, where the researcher has the power gap with the participants.
- ④ It is based on bracketing of any pre-conceived ideas.

⑤ Rejects the preconceived notion.

Demerits

① Too much subjectivity, led to manipulation of data.

② Cannot be generalised.

③ It questions on validity and credibility of data.

④ It seems to be vague & abstract.

Examples of phenomenology

① Travis Martin: Home coming of USA war veterans, were feeling trauma, after they realised their family members have adjusted to live without him.

② Paul Farmer: used in HIV disease treatment.

③ Dewis Leclerc: analysed the relation of health & illness in the poor family. People pray for death of diseased, to save the income.

Thus, we can see how the phenomenology has changed ¹⁴⁶⁷ ethnography.